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News

JUST IN: Katie Cristol says she will not seek reelection next year

By **ARLnow.com**

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Katie Cristol (Staff Photo by Jay Westcott)

Arlington County Board Chair Katie Cristol does not plan to run for reelection in 2023.

Cristol confirmed her decision to ARLnow last night, after it was mentioned near the bottom of a [Washington Post article](#) about Tuesday's [election](#).

She released the following statement about her decision.

I plan to conclude my service on the Board after two terms for a number of reasons. Among the most important is the same reason I decided to run in the first place: Arlington is stronger when the full community is represented, and it's time to make room for new perspectives.

In 2015, I argued that representation of the County's growing plurality — under 35, renter (or in my case then, very recent renter and new homeowner), resident of our urban corridors — would benefit everyone. I believe that many of our accomplishments over the past eight years have borne that out. Young professional talent has been a key asset in Arlington's major economic development achievements

like landing Amazon's HQ2, for instance. Major expansions in our supply of childcare for families have significantly improved our whole community's resiliency. Having transit riders represent Arlington on, and chair, regional bodies as we achieved landmark infrastructure investments (in VRE, in the Long Bridge expansion, in the historic Metro capital funding agreement) has helped knit our whole region closer together and has elevated the County's role in that region.

Eight years on, there's a new generation that deserves its own chance to be heard. I've also had many conversations with community members over the past two years about race, equity and power in Arlington. For me, that's highlighted that "stage of life" isn't the only demographic experience that makes residents feel under- or unrepresented in decision-making in the County.

It's of course up to the voters to determine who will serve next. But in the same way that Arlington voters took a chance and gave me an opportunity in 2015, I want to make space for a new perspective on the County Board now. I really do believe we'll all benefit when we're all represented.

Cristol and Board Vice-Chair Christian Dorsey will be finishing up their [second term](#) next year. There have been [rumors](#) for months that neither are running again.

Dorsey did not tip his hand when reached for comment.

"I have no announcement to make at this time," he told ARLnow.

About the Author



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